UNIT 2

State



Dear Students, in the last chapter the discipline Political Science was introduced to you. Did you question what is Political Science dealing with? If Botany is concerned with the study of plants and sociology the study of society then what Political Science is about? What is the main focus of study of Political Science?

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Introduction

Political Science is the systematic study of State. We all live in State. The world is viewed as an embodiment of many States. State as an idea or a concept is derived from a historical process of political, cultural, religious and economic contexts of a region. Today when the word 'State' is mentioned and used it usually indicate the modern State. The world today comprises of modern States. Modern State is a public order completely different from the pre-modern notion comprising of a body politics consisting of the rulers and the ruled. Hence a proper understanding of what State is and what not is quite essential to students of political science.

Learning Objectives

- This explanatory chapter about the State will enable you to understand what are the major concerns of the study of political science especially what is State and its functions.
- Demonstrate the different views of various thinkers about the State.
- Introduce you the elements of the State.
- Facilitate you to identify the linkage between Society, State and Government.
- Familiarize the concepts of Modern State, Welfare State and Soft State.

2.1 Meaning and Definition of State

The State is the most universal and most powerful of all social institutions. The State is a natural institution. ***Aristotle*** said 'Man (Human) is a social animal and by nature s/he is a political being. To him, to live in the State and to be a man were identical. The modern term 'state' is derived from the word 'status'. It was ***Niccolo Machiavelli*** (1469 – 1527) who first used the term 'State' in his writings. The state is necessary because it comes

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